

aggressive dimming that some single-layer OLED panels apply.

The 144 Hz display is very smooth in use; scrolling through long pages and switching between apps feels more fluid than the 90 Hz or 60 Hz LCD alternatives in this segment.

Now the caveat is that the Asus Pad is Widevine L1 certified, which means the hardware is capable of streaming HD and Full HD content from major OTT platforms. The problem is that Netflix, Prime Video and JioHotstar require individual DRM certification beyond Widevine L1 and the Asus Pad has not received those certifications at launch. The result is that streaming on these platforms is limited to standard definition, which is a significant limitation for a 2.8K OLED display. This can be addressed via an OTA software update, so it is not a permanent hardware limitation, but buyers should verify the certification status before purchasing if streaming quality is the primary motivation.

PERFORMANCE

The MediaTek Dimensity 8300 (4 nm) is a solid mid-range chip that punches above its category in tablet use. Our AnTuTu score came in at 1,585,057, which is competitive for the price. Geekbench returned 1,186 in single-core and 4,077 in multi-core. PCMark Work scored 14,156, and the 3DMark Wildlife Extreme score of 3,034 suggests the Mali G615-MC6 GPU is capable of handling casual and mid-intensity gaming without trouble. CPU throttling held at 88% of peak performance during sustained loads, which means the chip maintains most of its output under pressure rather than dropping significantly.

Day-to-day use is smooth with app launches, multitasking between a browser, streaming app and note-taking app simultaneously, and 144 Hz scrolling all feel responsive. The 8 GB of LPDDR5X RAM keeps things moving without hesitation and Wi-Fi 6E handles fast network connections when on a compatible router.

The software is Android 16, running close to stock. This is functional and clean, but it misses an opportunity. A 12.2-inch display with a 3:2 aspect ratio, well-suited to split-screen multitasking and productivity workflows, would benefit from a tablet-optimised UI layer. Asus's own ZenUI, which ships on its smartphones, offers multitasking conveniences and a more considered panel management system. The stock Android experience works but does not take full advantage of the screen real estate.

What the software does well is Android 16's split-screen multitasking, Google Circle to Search, and ASUS GlideX for cross-device connectivity. GlideX allows the Asus Pad to act as a secondary display for a Windows or macOS laptop, mirror a phone screen, transfer files wirelessly and share a single keyboard and mouse across devices. It works across Asus and non-Asus devices and is available as a free download. For students and multi-device users, it is a welcome addition.

AUDIO: LOUD AND SPACIOUS

The quad-speaker system with Dolby Atmos 360° is one of the Asus Pad's stronger supporting acts. The four speakers (8Ω/1.0 W each) produce a noticeably wide soundstage for a tablet, with reasonable bass presence and clear dialogue. Positioned in landscape mode for video content, the stereo separation between the left and right pairs is effective. At higher volumes, the sound stays clean without obvious harshness or distortion. For a device in this price range, the audio punches well above expectations and paired with the OLED display it creates a solid environment for films and shows once the OTT certification issue is resolved.

– Siddharth Chauhan

SPECIFICATIONS

SoC: MediaTek Dimensity 8300 | GPU: Mali G615-MC6 | Display: 12.2-inch dual-layer OLED, 2800 x 1840 | Brightness: 2000 nits | Refresh Rate: 144 Hz | RAM: 8 GB LPDDR5X | Storage: 256 GB UFS 3.1 | Battery: 9000 mAh | Charging: 45W | Camera (rear): 13MP | Camera (Front): 5 MP | Connectivity: Wi-Fi 6E, Bluetooth 5.3, USB-C 3.0

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